[INCH-POUND]
A-A-1823B
March 6, 1995
SUPERSEDING
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July 24, 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RIBBON, FLAGGING, SURVEYOR'S (PLASTIC, FLUORESCENT COLORS)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This commercial item description covers fluorescent colored plastic ribbon, often referred to as "glow colors", for use as a flagging marker in field survey work and for otherwise designating or identifying specific outdoor objects and locations.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

2.1 Description. Plastic flagging ribbon shall be fabricated from flexible vinyl plastic film. Plasticizers used shall be appropriate for the ribbons to remain supple at minus 20 degrees F (minus 29 degrees C), when tested in accordance with 5.1.3. The ribbon shall be embossed. The color shall be as specified in the procurement documents.

2.1.1 Dimensions. Prior to embossing, the plastic film shall have a measured thickness between 0.0034 (0.0086cm) and 0.0040 (0.010cm) inch (3.4 and 4.0 mil); the finished thickness after embossing shall measure between 0.0040 (0.010cm) and 0.0050 (0.012cm) inch (4.0 and 5.0 mil). Width of ribbon shall be 1-3/16 inches (3.01cm), plus or minus 1/32 inch (0.079cm). Each roll shall contain 50 yards (45.72 meters), plus 2.5 yards (2.29 meters)/minus 0 yards (0 meters), of plastic ribbon.

2.1.2 Weight. The 50 yard (45.72 meters) roll, less core, shall weigh a minimum of 4.8 ounces (136.07 grams). Weight per roll shall be determined by using specific gravity as determined in accordance with ASTM D792 and the following formula:

yards/lb. = .77/(SG X width X thickness).

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor St., Fort Worth, TX 76102

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FSC 9905

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2.1.3 Colorfastnes . The red flagging ribbon shall show no change in basic color, *when examined visually, after 276 hours in a xenon arc fade-o-meter/weather-o-meter. The remaining color flagging ribbon shall show no change in basic color, *when examined visually, after 192 hours in a xenon arc fade-o-meter/weather-o-meter, when tested in accordance with paragraph 5.1.4.

*The Basic color may be faded or a lighter shade but the original color is still identifiable and recognizable.

2.2 Workmanship. The ribbon shall be free of holes, dirt, ragged edges, discoloration, and suitable for the purpose intended. No defects that affect appearance or serviceability shall be permitted.

2.3 Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

2.4 Standard commercial product. The ribbon shall, as a minimum, be in accordance with the requirements of this CID and shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product. A standard commercial product is a product which has been sold or is currently offered for sale on the commercial market through advertisements, manufacturer's catalogs, or brochures, and represents the latest production model.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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5. TESTING

5.1 Testing.

5.1.1 Weight. Weight per roll without core shall be determined by using a balance readable to 0.1 gram or less.

5.1.2 Thickness. The gage used for the measurement of thickness shall be a dead weight type equipped with a dial graduated to read directly to 0.0001 inch (0.0025cm). The presser foot shall be circular with a diameter of 0.25 inch (0.63cm) plus or minus 0.01 inch (0.025cm). The presser foot and moving parts connected therewith shall be weighted so as to apply a total load of 3 ounce (85.05 grams) plus or minus 0.1 ounce (2.835 grams) to the specimen. The presser foot and anvil surface shall be plane to within 0.0001 inch (0.00025cm) and parallel to each other within 0.0001 inch (0.00025cm).

5.1.3 Low Temperature Resistance Test. Three eight-inch (20.32cm) lengths of the finished ribbon from each sample unit shall be exposed in a cold chamber to a temperature of minus 20 degrees F (minus 29 degrees C) plus or minus 4 degrees F (4 degrees C) for a period of one hour. Without being removed from the cold chamber, the specimen shall be creased 180 degrees in the center by folding slightly while lying on a flat smooth surface and running the center of a steel roller over the fold a single time. The steel roller shall be approximately 5.5 inches (13.97cm) in diameter, approximately 2 inches (5.08cm) wide, with a suitable handle guide, and shall weigh 10 pounds (4.53 Kg) plus or minus 0.5 pounds (0.23 Kg). The temperature of the roller shall be the same as that of the specimen. The specimen shall be handled with gloves and care taken that its temperature remains uniform through the test. After folding the specimen shall be visually examined. Any indication of cracking or flaking of any specimen shall be cause for rejection of the sample.

5.1.4 Colorfastness. The finished ribbon shall be exposed for the specified number of hours in accordance with ASTM G26, method A or C and examined for compliance with 2.1.3.

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Sources of documents.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM), 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

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7.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurements documents (if applicable).

a. Title, number and date of this commercial item description.
b. The color of flagging ribbon required.
c. The preservation, packing, and marking desired.

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

USDA - AFS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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